

# The Amalekites

This document focuses on the **Amalekites**, a biblical people who were descendants of Esau.

The Amalekites were **wicked, oppressive, warlike, cruel**, and governed by kings. They lived in the south of Canaan and were a powerful and influential nation.

The Amalekites were the **first to oppose Israel** after they came out of Egypt. Because of this, and other acts of aggression against Israel, God **doomed the Amalekites to utter destruction**. Saul was commanded by God to destroy the Amalekites, but he disobeyed and did not completely destroy them. Later, during the reign of Hezekiah, the **remaining Amalekites were completely destroyed**.

### *Descent of.*

**Genesis 36:12.** And Timna was concubine to Eliphaz Esau's son; and she bare to Eliphaz Amalek: these were the sons of Adah Esau's wife.

**Genesis 36:16.** Duke Korah, Duke Gatam, and Duke Amalek: these are the dukes that came of Eliphaz in the land of Edom; these were the sons of Adah.

### **CHARACTER OF;**

#### **Wicked.**

**1 Samuel 15:18.** And the LORD sent thee on a journey, and said, Go and utterly destroy the sinners the Amalekites, and fight against them until they be consumed.

#### **Oppressive.**

**Judges 10:12.** The Zidonians also, and the Amalekites, and the Maonites, did oppress you; and ye cried to me, and I delivered you out of their hand.

#### **Warlike and cruel.**

**1 Samuel 15:33.** And Samuel said, As thy sword hath made Women childless, so shall thy mother be childless among women. And Samuel hewed Agag in pieces before the LORD in Gilgal.

#### **Governed by Kings.**

**1 Samuel 15:20.** And Saul said unto Samuel, Yea, I have obeyed the voice of the LORD, and have gone the way which the LORD sent me, and have brought Agag the king of Amalek, and have utterly destroyed the Amalekites.

**1 Samuel 15:32.** Then said Samuel, Bring ye hither to me Agag the king of the Amalekites. And Agag came unto him delicately. And Agag said, Surely the bitterness of Death is past.

#### **A powerful and influential nation.**

**Numbers 24:7.** He shall pour the water out of his buckets, and his seed shall be in many

waters, and his king shall be higher than Agag, and his kingdom shall be exalted.

### **Possessed cities.**

**1 Samuel 15:5.** And Saul came to a city of Amalek, and laid wait in the valley.

## **COUNTRY OF,**

### **In the south of Canaan.**

**Numbers 13:29.** The Amalekites dwell in the land of the south: and the Hittites, and the Jebusites, and the Amorites, dwell in the mountains: and the Canaanites dwell by the sea, and by the Coast of Jordan.

**1 Samuel 27:8.** And David and his men went up, and invaded the Geshurites, and the Gezrites, and the Amalekites: for those nations were of old the inhabitants of the land, as thou goest to Shur, even unto the land of Egypt.

### **Extended from Havilah to Shur.**

**1 Samuel 15:7.** And Saul smote the Amalekites from Havilah until thou comest to Shur, that is over against Egypt.

### ***Was the scene of ancient warfare.***

**Genesis 14:7.** And they returned, and came to Enmishpat, which is Kadesh, and smote all the country of the Amalekites, and also the Amorites, that dwelt in Hazezontamar.

### ***Part of the Kenites dwelt amongst.***

**1 Samuel 15:6.** And Saul said unto the Kenites, Go, depart, get you down from among the Amalekites, lest I destroy you with them: for ye shewed kindness to all the children of Israel, when they came up out of Egypt. So the Kenites departed from among the Amalekites.

### ***Were the first to oppose Israel.***

**Exodus 17:8.** Then came Amalek, and fought with Israel in Rephidim.

### ***Discomfited at Rephidim, through the intercession of Moses.***

**Exodus 17:9-13.** And Moses said unto Joshua, Choose us out men, and go out, fight with

Amalek: to morrow I will stand on the top of the hill with the rod of God in mine hand. So Joshua did as Moses had said to him, and fought with Amalek: and Moses, Aaron, and Hur went up to the top of the hill. And it came to pass, when Moses held up his hand, that Israel prevailed: and when he let down his hand, Amalek prevailed. But Moses' hands were heavy; and they took a stone, and put it under him, and he sat thereon; and Aaron and Hur stayed up his hands, the one on the one side, and the other on the other side; and his hands were steady until the going down of the sun. ...

***Doomed to utter destruction for opposing Israel.***

**Exodus 17:14.** And the LORD said unto Moses, Write this for a memorial in a book, and rehearse it in the ears of Joshua: for I will utterly put out the remembrance of Amalek from under heaven.

**Exodus 17:16.** For he said, Because the LORD hath sworn that the LORD will have war with Amalek from generation to generation.

***Their utter destruction foretold.***

**Numbers 24:20.** And when he looked on Amalek, he took up his parable, and said, Amalek was the first of the nations; but his latter end shall be that he perish for ever.

***Presumption of Israel Punished by.***

**Numbers 14:45.** Then the Amalekites came down, and the Canaanites which dwelt in that hill, and smote them, and Discomfited them, even unto Hormah.

***United with Eglon against Israel.***

**Judges 3:13.** And he gathered unto him the children of Ammon and Amalek, and went and smote Israel, and possessed the city of palm trees.

***Part of their possessions taken by Ephraim.***

**Judges 5:14.** Out of Ephraim was there a root of them against Amalek; after thee, Benjamin, among thy people; out of Machir came down Governors, and out of Zebulun they that handle

the pen of the writer.

**Judges 12:15.** And Abdon the son of Hillel the Pirathonite died, and was buried in Pirathon in the land of Ephraim, in the mount of the Amalekites.

### *With Midian, oppressed Israel.*

**Judges 6:3-5.** And so it was, when Israel had sown, that the Midianites came up, and the Amalekites, and the children of the east, even they came up against them; And they encamped against them, and destroyed the increase of the earth, till thou come unto Gaza, and left no sustenance for Israel, neither sheep, nor ox, nor ass. For they came up with their cattle and their tents, and they came as grasshoppers for multitude; for both they and their camels were without number: and they entered into the land to destroy it.

### *Overcome by Gideon.*

**Judges 6:33.** Then all the Midianites and the Amalekites and the children of the east were gathered together, and went over, and pitched in the valley of Jezreel.

**Judges 7:21-22.** And they stood every man in his place round about the camp: and all the host ran, and cried, and fled. And the three hundred blew the trumpets, and the LORD set every man's sword against his fellow, even throughout all the host: and the host fled to Bethshittah in Zererath, and to the border of Abelmeholah, unto Tabbath.

## **SAUL**

**Overcame, and delivered Israel.**

**1 Samuel 14:48.** And he gathered an host, and smote the Amalekites, and delivered Israel out of the hands of them that spoiled them.

### **Commissioned to destroy.**

**1 Samuel 15:1-3.** Samuel also said unto Saul, The LORD sent me to anoint thee to be king over his people, over Israel: now therefore hearken thou unto the voice of the words of the LORD. Thus saith the LORD of hosts, I remember that which Amalek did to Israel, how he laid wait for him in the way, when he came up from Egypt. Now go and smite Amalek, and utterly destroy all that they have, and spare them not; but slay both man and woman, infant and suckling, ox and sheep, camel and ass.

### **Massacred.**

**1 Samuel 15:4-8.** And Saul gathered the people together, and numbered them in Telaim, two hundred thousand footmen, and ten thousand men of Judah. And Saul came to a city of Amalek, and laid wait in the valley. And Saul said unto the Kenites, Go, depart, get you down from among the Amalekites, lest I destroy you with them: for ye shewed kindness to all the children of Israel, when they came up out of Egypt. So the Kenites departed from among the Amalekites. And Saul smote the Amalekites from Havilah until thou comest to Shur, that is over against Egypt. ...

### **Condemned for not utterly destroying.**

**1 Samuel 15:9-26.** But Saul and the people spared Agag, and the best of the sheep, and of the oxen, and of the fatlings, and the lambs, and all that was good, and would not utterly destroy them: but every thing that was vile and refuse, that they destroyed utterly. Then came the word of the LORD unto Samuel, saying, 11 It repenteth me that I have set up Saul to be king: for he is turned back from following me, and hath not performed my commandments. And it grieved Samuel; and he cried unto the LORD all night. And when Samuel rose early to meet Saul in the morning, it was told Samuel, saying, Saul came to Carmel, and, behold, he set him up a place, and is gone about, and passed on, and gone down to Gilgal. ...

**1 Samuel 28:18.** Because thou obeyedst not the voice of the LORD, nor executedst his fierce wrath upon Amalek, therefore hath the LORD done this thing unto thee this day.

***Agag, king of, slain by Samuel.***

**1 Samuel 15:32-33.** Then said Samuel, Bring ye hither to me Agag the king of the Amalekites. And Agag came unto him delicately. And Agag said, Surely the bitterness of Death is past. And Samuel said, As thy sword hath made Women childless, so shall thy mother be childless among women. And Samuel hewed Agag in pieces before the LORD in Gilgal.

***Invaded by David.***

**1 Samuel 27:8-9.** And David and his men went up, and invaded the Geshurites, and the Gezrites, and the Amalekites: for those nations were of old the inhabitants of the land, as thou goest to Shur, even unto the land of Egypt. And David smote the land, and left neither man nor woman alive, and took away the sheep, and the oxen, and the asses, and the camels, and the apparel, and returned, and came to Achish.

***Pillaged and burned Ziklag.***

**1 Samuel 30:1-2.** And it came to pass, when David and his men were come to Ziklag on the third day, that the Amalekites had invaded the south, and Ziklag, and smitten Ziklag, and burned it with fire; And had taken the Women captives, that were therein: they slew not any, either great or small, but carried them away, and went on their way.



*Pursued and slain by David.*

**1 Samuel 30:10-20.** But David pursued, he and four hundred men: for two hundred Abode behind, which were so faint that they could not go over the brook Besor. And they found an Egyptian in the field, and brought him to David, and gave him bread, and he did eat; and they made him drink water; And they gave him a piece of a cake of figs, and two clusters of raisins: and when he had eaten, his spirit came again to him: for he had eaten no bread, nor drunk any water, three days and three nights. And David said unto him, To whom belongest thou? and whence Art thou? And he said, I am a young man of Egypt, Servant to an Amalekite; and my master left me, because three days Agone I fell sick. ...

*Spoil taken from, consecrated.*

**2 Samuel 8:11-12.** Which also king David did dedicate unto the LORD, with the silver and gold that he had dedicated of all nations which he subdued; Of Syria, and of Moab, and of the children of Ammon, and of the Philistines, and of Amalek, and of the spoil of Hadadezer, son of Rehob, king of Zobah.

*Confederated against Israel.*

**Psalms 83:7.** Gebal, and Ammon, and Amalek; the Philistines with the inhabitants of Tyre;

***Remnant of, completely destroyed during the reign of Hezekiah.***

**1 Chronicles 4:41-43.** And these written by name came in the days of Hezekiah king of Judah, and smote their tents, and the habitations that were found there, and destroyed them utterly unto this day, and dwelt in their rooms: because there was pasture there for their flocks. And some of them, even of the sons of Simeon, five hundred men, went to mount Seir, having for their Captains Pelatiah, and Neariah, and Rephaiah, and Uzziel, the sons of Ishi. And they smote the rest of the Amalekites that were escaped, and dwelt there unto this day.